

CHORUS-Skid SGH-1: A Proof-of-Concept Framework for Pressure-Retarded Osmosis on Anthropogenic Brine Gradients

with Acoustic Harvest, Ultrasonic Membrane Assist, and Column-Scale Multi-Physics Energy Accounting

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Abstract

Anthropogenic desalination reject (1400 mol/m^3) against treated effluent (5 mol/m^3) creates $\Delta\pi = 6.92 \text{ MPa}$ — $2.4\times$ estuary RED reference. We present CHORUS multi-layer column accounting and CHORUS-Skid SGH-1 PRO bench hardware with AEH acoustic coupling.

Kim–Baker $\Delta P^* = 35 \text{ bar}$. Monte Carlo column ($N=8000$): median 22.9 MW/km^2 . PRO model: 1.66 W vs 10 W target; $L_p^* = 6.03\text{e-}12$. Seven figures, full layer derivations (A–F), 23-part CAD, T0–T2 protocols. Tier-1 vs tier-2 claims explicit.

Keywords: pressure-retarded osmosis; salinity-gradient power; blue energy; reverse electrodialysis; concentration polarization; acoustic energy harvesting; CHORUS; desalination brine; proof of concept

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Nomenclature

Table 1. Symbols used throughout this report.

Symbol	Definition	SI
R, F	Gas constant; Faraday constant	J/(mol·K); C/mol
T	Absolute temperature	K
i	Van't Hoff factor (NaCl)	—
$c, \pi, \Delta\pi$	Concentration; osmotic pressure; difference	mol/m ³ ; Pa
$\Delta P, \Delta P^*$	Hydraulic pressure; Kim–Baker optimum	Pa
L_p, B	Water permeability; salt permeability	m/(Pa·s); m/s
A, A_k	Membrane area; layer footprint	m ²
$\mathbf{V}_w, J_w$	Volumetric flux; water flux	m ³ /s; m/s
E_N, V_{oc}	Nernst potential; stack open circuit	V
R_{int}	Area-specific internal resistance	$\Omega \cdot m^2$
P'', P_{target}	Areal power density; design power	W/m ² ; W
η_{mem}, η_{hyd}	Membrane; hydrodynamic efficiency	—
CF_k	Layer capacity factor	—
G	Conductance (TSC network)	S
ψ	Node potential	V
I, p_{rms}	Acoustic intensity; RMS pressure	W/m ² ; Pa
SPL	Sound pressure level	dB re 20 μ Pa
g	Ultrasonic flux gain factor	—
$\Pi_1 \dots \Pi_n$	Dimensionless groups (see Table 2)	—

1. Introduction

The twenty-first century expansion of desalination has created an overlooked by-product: continuous, high-grade salinity gradients at industrial sites. Every reverse-osmosis plant splits a feed stream into permeate and reject brine. Wastewater treatment plants discharge effluent at near-fresh salinity. Where these streams are co-located—as they are at coastal utilities worldwide—the Gibbs free energy of mixing is destroyed in outfalls and mixing zones. This manuscript asks whether that destruction can be reversed with physics-first engineering, honest thermodynamic accounting, and a bench-scale proof vehicle.

We introduce **CHORUS** (Columnar Harvest of Osmotic, Rhizospheric, Orographic, and Solar flux) as a multi-layer framework for a notional 1 km² coastal or industrial column. CHORUS does not claim a new fundamental energy source. It claims that *already-present* fluxes—solar, osmotic, moist-electric, biological, and atmospheric—can be inventoried, bounded, and partially converted if each pathway respects the second law. The governing postulate is explicit: $\Sigma P_{\text{extracted}} \leq \Sigma \dot{Q}_{\text{in}} - T \dot{S}_{\text{gen}}$.

The near-term hardware anchor is **CHORUS-Skid SGH-1**, a pressure-retarded osmosis (PRO) bench harness sized for 10 W equivalent output from anthropogenic brine (1400 mol/m³) against treated wastewater class feed (5 mol/m³). At $T = 298.15 \text{ K}$ this pair yields $\Delta\pi = 6.92 \text{ MPa}$ —2.4× the classic estuary RED reference. SGH-1 is accompanied by 23 OpenSCAD mechanical parts, a six-module Python simulation stack, DAQ logging, and test protocols T0–T2.

This paper is deliberately tiered. **Tier 1 (defensible)** includes Van't Hoff osmotic thermodynamics, Kim–Baker optimal hydraulic pressure, solution-diffusion water transport, concentration polarization film theory, and bench-sized PRO geometry. **Tier 2 (exploratory)** includes Telluric Storm Coupling (TSC) conductance networks, global fair-weather circuit routing, and column-scale Monte Carlo sums that reach 22.9 MW/km² median but are dominated by land photovoltaics—not osmotic area.

Readers should leave with three durable conclusions: (i) sidestream PRO on desal brine is the fastest credible PoC path; (ii) default membrane permeability must be bench-calibrated to close the gap between 1.66 W modeled and 10 W targeted; (iii) CHORUS column narratives are scaling context, not bench claims.

1.1 Problem statement

Desalination plants and wastewater treatment plants are often co-located at coasts. Brine disposal raises environmental and regulatory cost. Effluent discharge carries residual chemical potential. Coupling the two streams through a PRO module could offset parasitic plant load while reducing entropy waste—a win-win if membranes and controls are credible.

1.2 Document map

Section 2 reviews prior art. Section 3 derives Layers A–F with equations. Section 4 describes skid architecture and AEH. Section 5 covers simulation methods. Section 6 presents numerical experiments E1–E7. Sections 7–8 cover hardware and tests. Section 9 discusses claims hierarchy. Appendices contain sweep data and CAD index.

2. Background and prior art

Salinity-gradient power has been pursued along two electrochemical/hydraulic branches. **Reverse electrodialysis (RED)** places ion-exchange membranes between fresh and saline streams, generating Nernstian voltage and electrical current. Teng et al. (2026) report nanopore-engineered membranes achieving approximately 15 W/m² at estuary-grade concentrations—our Layer A calibration anchor.

Pressure-retarded osmosis (PRO) pressurizes the draw compartment and extracts work via turbine or pressure exchanger as water permeates from feed. Statkraft's Tofte pilot (2009–2013) demonstrated feasibility but highlighted fouling, CP, and parasitic pumping as commercial barriers. Anthropogenic brine pairs can exceed estuary $\Delta\pi$, trading membrane stress for higher volumetric driving force.

Parallel harvest physics appear in moisture-enabled generators (Air-gen), hydrovoltaic streaming, evaporatively cooled photovoltaics, and microbial fuel cells. Fang et al. (2026) couple PV waste heat to magnetohydrodynamic enhancement—a Layer B motif. Virgo et al. (2020) bound atmospheric electricity. CHORUS integrates these as layers with explicit capacity factors rather than as interchangeable 'green energy'.

Urban acoustic harvesting is not new; piezoelectric panels on noise-facing surfaces produce mW scales. Our AEH-1 module treats sound as (Mode A) supplemental rectified power and (Mode B) ultrasonic CP disruption on the PRO feed path—a coupling uncommon in osmotic power literature.

3. Theoretical framework

All layers satisfy the CHORUS postulate $\sum P_k \leq \sum \dot{Q}_{in} - T\dot{S}$. The following subsections mirror docs/CHORUS_MATH_PLAN.md and notebooks/CHORUS_physics_proof.ipynb.

3.1 Layer A — Osmotic mixing and blue energy (RED)

Layer A models osmotic mixing and blue energy at estuary-grade interfaces. For ideal NaCl with van't Hoff factor $i = 2$, $\pi = iRTc$. Mixing free energy for concentrated solutions underlies both RED and PRO; the difference is extraction mechanism (electrical vs hydraulic).

For $c_{sea} = 600 \text{ mol/m}^3$ and $c_{river} = 20 \text{ mol/m}^3$ at 298.15 K: $\Delta\pi = 2.876 \text{ MPa}$. Single-pair Nernst potential $E_N = 87.39 \text{ mV}$; fifty pairs yield $V_{oc} = 4.37 \text{ V}$. The electrical max-power theorem for linear internal resistance gives $P'_{max} = V_{oc}^2 / (4R_{int})$. Calibrating to literature $P_{blue} = 15 \text{ W/m}^2$ implies $R_{int} = 0.318 \Omega \cdot \text{m}^2$.

The Gibbs hydraulic mixing ceiling $P_{mix} = \Delta\pi \cdot Q$ with illustrative $Q = 500 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$ gives 1438 MW—an upper bound on mechanical work available if all fresh water flux could be converted reversibly. Real membranes achieve a fraction of this; RED demonstrations target interface power density, not bulk mixing flow.

Nanopore conductance models introduce slip length b : $G(b) = G_0(1 + 2b/h)$. Higher slip increases areal conductance and hence power at fixed $\Delta\pi$. This is a materials-science lever distinct from stacking more membrane area—important when land or interface area is constrained.

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta G_{mix} &= 2RT V [c_+ \ln(c_+/c_-) - (c_+ - c_-)] \\ \pi &= i R T c \\ \Delta\pi &= \pi_{high} - \pi_{low} \\ E_N &= (R T / z F) \ln(a_{high} / a_{low}) \\ P'_{max} &= V_{oc}^2 / (4 R_{int}) \\ P_{mix,max} &= \Delta\pi Q\end{aligned}$$

3.2 Layer B — Moist-electric and hydrovoltaic

Layer B addresses moist-electric and hydrovoltaic pathways (CHOR sub-layer). Water vapor chemical potential $\mu_v = \mu_v^\circ + RT \ln(a_w)$ drives Fickian flux through porous media. Asymmetric nanopores with different top/bottom opening areas produce net charge separation (Air-gen class): $I_q = e \Delta\Gamma q_{trans}$.

Helmholtz–Smoluchowski streaming links pressure gradients in fine channels to streaming potential $E_s = (\epsilon\zeta/\sigma\eta) \Delta p$. Power densities are typically mW/m² unless channel density and wetting are extreme.

The coupled PV–thermal node in our notebook solves $C_{th} dT_s/dt = \alpha_s G_{solar} - h_c(T_s - T_\infty) - L_v \dot{m}_e - P_{hybrid}$. Steady evaporative cooling yields $P_{pv} \approx 187.9 \text{ W/m}^2$ with incremental gain $\Delta P \approx 5.6 \text{ W/m}^2$ versus uncooled baseline—dominant in column Monte Carlo.

CHORUS-Skid reserves plenum volume in chorus_skid_enclosure.scad for future moist-electric panels; v1 hardware validates PRO and AEH while keeping thermal ports on the critical path for v2 integration.

$$\mu_v = \mu_v^\circ + R T \ln(a_w)$$

$$I_q = e \Delta \Gamma q_{\text{trans}}$$

$$E_s = (\epsilon \zeta / \sigma \eta) \Delta p$$

$$C_{\text{th}} dT_s/dt = \alpha_s G_{\text{solar}} - h_c(T_s - T_\infty) - L_v \dot{m}_e - P_{\text{hybrid}}$$

3.3 Layer C — Rhizospheric harvest

Layer C covers rhizospheric harvest: sediment microbial fuel cells (SMFC) and piezoelectrotrophy. Butler–Volmer kinetics $j = j_0 [\exp(\alpha_a F \eta / RT) - \exp(-\alpha_c F \eta / RT)]$ bound anodic current. Power density $P = j(E_0 - b \log j - R_\Omega j)$ peaks at intermediate current density.

Notebook §V reports $P_{\text{MFC}} \approx 36.7 \mu\text{W}/\text{m}^2$ —real biology, not a land-area leader. Piezoelectrotrophy couples mechanical stress from root growth, rain, or freeze–thaw to η_{pzt} P_{mech} feeding parallel bioelectrogenic pathways (NSO 2026 paradigm).

In column accounting, SMFC receives full 1 km^2 area with $CF = 1.0$ but tiny P —its median contribution is orders of magnitude below p_v_{hydro} . CHORUS includes SMFC to avoid cherry-picking layers, not to sell soil power.

$$j = j_0 [\exp(\alpha_a F \eta / RT) - \exp(-\alpha_c F \eta / RT)]$$

$$P = j (E_0 - b \log j - R_\Omega j)$$

$$\dot{m}_{\text{bio}} = \eta_{\text{pzt}} P_{\text{mech}}$$

3.4 Layer D — Atmospheric charge

Layer D bounds atmospheric charge harvest. Fair-weather global circuit current $I_{\text{glob}} \sim 1\text{--}3 \text{ kA}$ across ionosphere–surface potential $200\text{--}400 \text{ kV}$ gives $P_{\text{glob}} \sim 0.25\text{--}0.9 \text{ GW}$ planet-wide.

Our illustrative anchor $P_{\text{glob}} = 0.6 \text{ GW}$ implies areal mean $\sim 10 \text{ W}/\text{m}^2$ —useful for order-of-magnitude routing stories, not farm-scale revenue.

Mason-type collision charging $dq/dt \propto n_d^2 \pi d^2 v_{\text{rel}} \Delta q$ produces episodic power in storm cells. Tornado kinetic energy $K = \frac{1}{2} \rho V_{\text{tor}} \pi (D/2)^2 H$ is included as sanity check only—GW episodic, not baseload.

$$P_{\text{glob}} = I_{\text{glob}} V$$

$$dq/dt \propto n_d^2 \pi d^2 v_{\text{rel}} \Delta q$$

3.5 Telluric Storm Coupling and column balance

Telluric Storm Coupling (TSC) models atmosphere (a), soil (s), and estuary/water (w) as a three-node conductance network $G\psi = I$. Dissipated power $P_{\text{TSC}} = \psi^2 G\psi$ routes charge—it does not create it.

High-impedance harvesters (MEG, SMFC) benefit if a low-impedance path exists to a sink. TSC is architectural coupling for utilization, analogous to power electronics MPPT rather than a new turbine.

Conductances G_{as} , G_{sw} , G_{a0} in the notebook are *illustrative Siemens* pending field instrumentation. PoC papers must label TSC figures as scenario analysis, not measured coastal data.

The column balance $P_{column} = \sum_k A_k CF_k \Psi_k$ is evaluated with lognormal uncertainty on each layer's areal power density. Replicated Monte Carlo ($N = 8000$) gives median 22.91 MW, P10 19.67 MW, P90 26.69 MW for a 1 km² parcel.

Layer median shares: blue_energy 1.1%, pv_hydro 98.7%, meg 0.05%, smfc 0.00%. Policy and civilizational narratives must respect this hierarchy.

$$\begin{aligned} G \Psi &= I \\ P_{TSC} &= \Psi G \Psi \\ P_{column} &= \sum_k A_k CF_k \Psi_k \end{aligned}$$

3.6 Layer F — PRO on anthropogenic brine

Layer F is the engineering core: PRO on anthropogenic brine. Draw concentration $c_d \approx 1400$ mol/m³ (~8 wt% NaCl reject) and feed $c_f \approx 5$ mol/m³ (treated wastewater class) give the strongest $\Delta\pi$ in our study.

$\Delta\pi = 6.916$ MPa; Kim–Baker optimum $\Delta P^* = 34.6$ bar. Water permeates according to $V_w = L_p A(\Delta\pi - \Delta P)$. Hydraulic power $P_{hyd} = \rho V_w \Delta P$; equivalent electrical power applies $\eta_{mem} \eta_{hyd}$.

SGH-1 targets $P_{target} = 10$ W at $P_{design} = 8$ W/m², yielding $A_{mem} = 0.72$ m² implemented as 12 plates of 200×300 mm active area each.

With default $L_p = 1 \times 10^{12}$ m/(Pa·s), steady model predicts $P = 1.66$ W ($\Pi = 0.166$). Inverse sizing gives $L_p^* = 6.03e-12$ m/(Pa·s) to hit 10 W—primary bench acceptance metric for T1 ($\pm 30\%$).

Concentration polarization $c_w/c_b = \exp(J_w/k_m)$ reduces effective $\Delta\pi$. Ultrasonic assist (AEH Mode B) models permeability gain g ; net power subtracts P_{US} driver load. Feed flow Q_{feed} from model sets hydraulic residence time; simulated $Q = 0.149$ L/min must be validated against rotameters.

Functional requirement FR-1 mandates $0.4 \leq \Delta P/\Delta\pi \leq 0.6$. Numerical experiment E1 confirms maximum at 0.5. Operating outside this band sacrifices power or risks over-pressurization relative to membrane burst pressure.

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta\pi &= i R T (c_{draw} - c_{feed}) \\ V_w &= L_p A (\Delta\pi - \Delta P) \\ \Delta P^* &= \Delta\pi / 2 \\ P &= \eta_{mem} \eta_{hyd} \rho V_w \Delta P \\ c_w / c_b &= \exp(J_w / k_m) \\ P_{net} &= P_{PRO}(g) - P_{US} - P_0 \end{aligned}$$

4. CHORUS-Skid system architecture

CHORUS-Skid integrates SGH-1 (PRO core), AEH-1 (acoustic), CHOR-01 (enclosure), and DAQ. Design exports in exports/sgh1_design.json drive OpenSCAD via generated_constants.scad.

4.1 Functional requirements

Table 2. SGH-1 functional requirements.

ID	Requirement
FR-1	Operate at $0.4 \leq \Delta P / \Delta \pi \leq 0.6$
FR-2	Feed ≤ 10 bar; draw rated to ΔP^*
FR-3	Log P, Q, $\sigma \times 2$, $T \times 2$ continuously
FR-4	Brine leak containment (drip tray)
FR-5	Removable membrane cartridge

4.2 AEH acoustic layer

AEH-1 (Acoustic Energy Harvest) mounts on the CHORUS skid frame with six-by-four Helmholtz-inspired cells (chorus_aeh_panel.scad). **Mode A** converts incident acoustic intensity $I = p_{rms}^2 / (\rho c)$ to electrical power $P = \eta I A$. At $\eta = 2\%$ and $A = 0.5 \text{ m}^2$, urban SPL 90–96 dB yields sub-watt to few-mW harvest—supplemental to DAQ, not baseload.

Mode B drives 28 kHz ultrasonic transducers on the feed manifold to disrupt CP. Modeled as multiplicative gain g on L_p , net benefit requires $P_{PRO}(g) - P_{US} - P_0 > 0$. Experiment E5 shows crossover near $g \approx 1.5$ at 1.5 W/m^2 ultrasonic parasitic for $A = 0.72 \text{ m}^2$.

Co-location with traffic, desal pumps, and HVAC plant noise is deliberate: Layer E in the original CHORUS vision treats cities as acoustic environments. Honest accounting keeps Mode A at mW and Mode B contingent on bench proof.

$$I = p_{rms}^2 / (\rho c)$$
$$P_{AEH} = \eta I A$$
$$P_{net} = P_{PRO}(g) - P_{US} - P_0$$

5. Numerical methods

5.1 Software modules

simulation/pro_cycle.py — steady PRO state; sizing.py — area scale law and CAD caps; membrane_transport.py — CP profile; ultrasonic_cp_gain.py — Mode B; acoustic_harvest.py — Mode A; pi_groups.py — $\Pi_{\text{blue}}-\Pi_{\text{red}}$; experiments.py — sweeps E1–E7. notebooks/CHORUS_physics_proof.ipynb — SymPy + SciPy proof; SGH1_PRO_simulation.ipynb — PRO/AEH.

5.2 Constants and assumptions

Table 3. Simulation defaults.

Parameter	Value	Source
T	298.15 K	constants.py
$\eta_{\text{mem}}, \eta_{\text{hyd}}$	0.35, 0.55	defaults
L_p (default)	1×10^{-12} m/(Pa·s)	placeholder until T1
ρ	1000 kg/m ³	water
$P''_{\text{blue anchor}}$	15 W/m ²	literature RED

5.3 Experiment matrix

Table 4. Numerical experiment matrix.

ID	Sweep	Points	Purpose
E1	$\Delta P/\Delta \pi$	41	Kim–Baker verification
E2	L_p	8	Inverse sizing for 10 W
E3	Salinity pairs	4	RED vs PRO $\Delta \pi$
E4	J_w (CP)	6	Polarization loss
E5	Ultrasonic g	7	Mode B net gain
E6	SPL	21	Mode A harvest
E7	Column MC	8000	Layer medians

6. Results and numerical experiments

6.1 SGH-1 baseline

Table 5. SGH-1 baseline at design concentrations.

Parameter	Value
$c_{\text{draw}} / c_{\text{feed}}$	1400 / 5 mol/m ³
$\Delta\pi$	6.916 MPa
ΔP^*	34.58 bar
A_{mem}	0.72 m ²
$P (L_p=1\text{e-}12)$	1.66 W
P''	2.30 W/m ²
Q_{feed}	0.149 L/min
E_N	144.8 mV

6.2 Dimensionless groups

Table 6. Dimensionless groups (pi_groups.py).

Group	Value	Meaning
Π_{KB}	0.500	At Kim–Baker point
Π_{CP}	0.692	Peclet order (CP)
Π_{AF}	0.576	Area law fill
Π_{10W}	0.166	Sim vs 10 W target
L_p^*	6.03e-12	m/(Pa·s) for 10 W

6.3 Experiment E1 — Hydraulic pressure ratio

Figure 1 plots P versus $\Delta P/\Delta\pi$. Maximum at 0.5 confirms Kim–Baker. FR-1 green band 0.4–0.6 captures operable range without approaching $\Delta\pi$ (where driving force vanishes).

SGH-1: PRO power vs hydraulic pressure ratio ($A = 0.72 \text{ m}^2$, $L_p = 1 \times 1$)

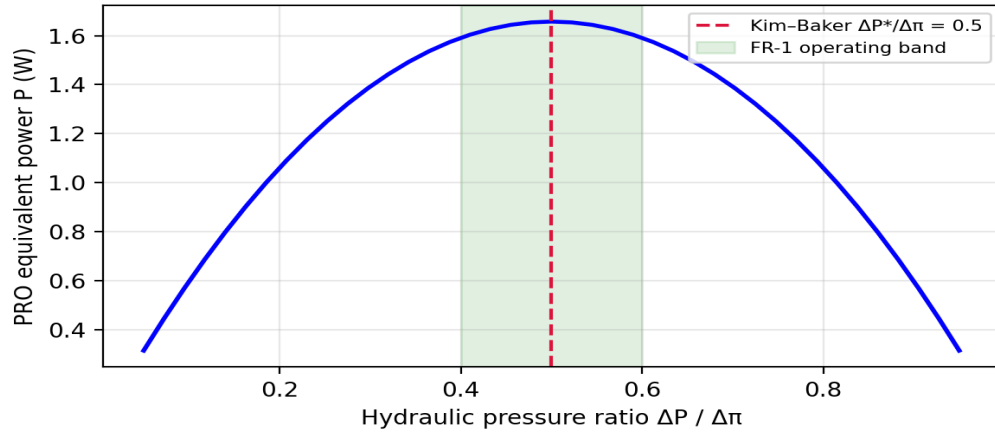


Figure 1. PRO power versus $\Delta P/\Delta \pi$ with FR-1 band and Kim-Baker optimum.

6.4 Experiment E2 — Permeability

$L_p^* \approx 6.03\text{e-}12 \text{ m}/(\text{Pa}\cdot\text{s})$ required for 10 W. Figure 2 shows sub-target performance at literature-placeholder L_p .

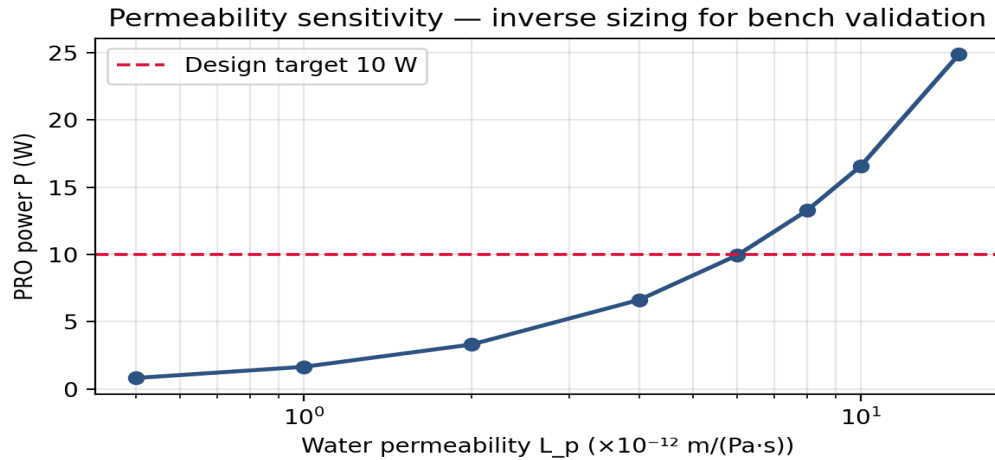


Figure 2. Power versus water permeability L_p .

6.5 Experiment E3 — Salinity pairs

Table 7. Salinity pair comparison.

Pair	c_d	c_f	$\Delta \pi$ MPa	E_N mV
Estuary RED	600	20	2.88	87.4
SGH-1 PRO	1400	5	6.92	144.8
Mid brine	1000	50	4.71	77.0
High gradient	1800	2	8.91	174.8

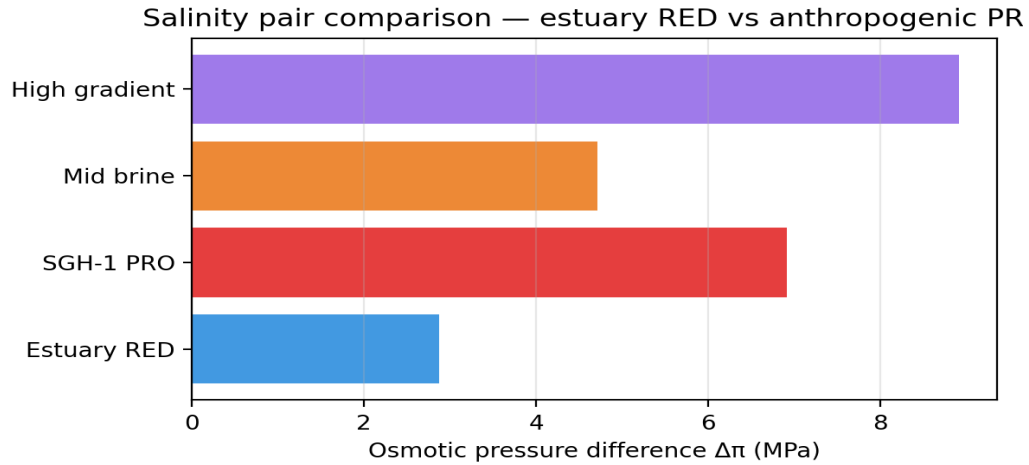


Figure 3. $\Delta\pi$ across estuary RED and anthropogenic PRO pairs.

6.6 Experiment E7 — Column Monte Carlo

Table 8. Column layer statistics (1 km², N=8000).

Layer	Median MW	Share %	P10	P90
blue_energy	0.26	1.1	0.18	0.39
pv_hydro	22.61	98.7	19.37	26.38
meg	0.01	0.0	0.01	0.02
smfc	0.00	0.0	0.00	0.00
Total	22.91	100	19.67	26.69

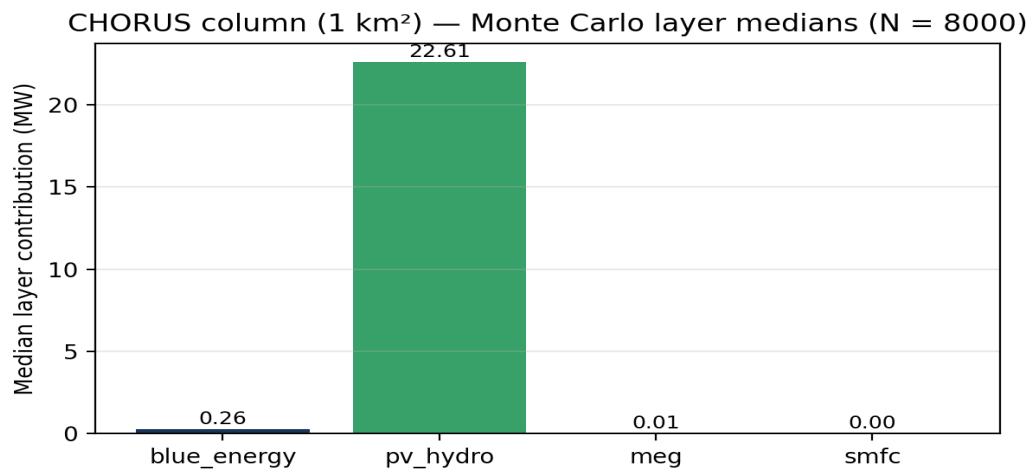


Figure 4. Median layer contributions.

6.7 Experiment E4 — Concentration polarization

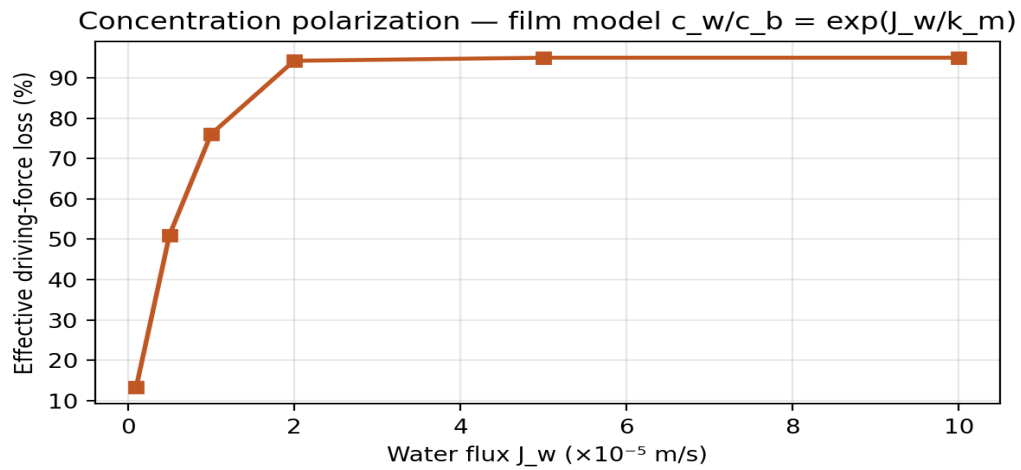


Figure 5. Driving-force loss versus water flux.

Table 9. CP film model results.

$J_w \times 10^{-5}$	c_w/c_b	Loss %
0.1	1.15	13.3
0.5	2.04	51.0
1.0	4.17	76.0
2.0	17.41	94.3
5.0	20.09	95.0
10.0	20.09	95.0

6.8 Experiment E5 — Ultrasonic assist

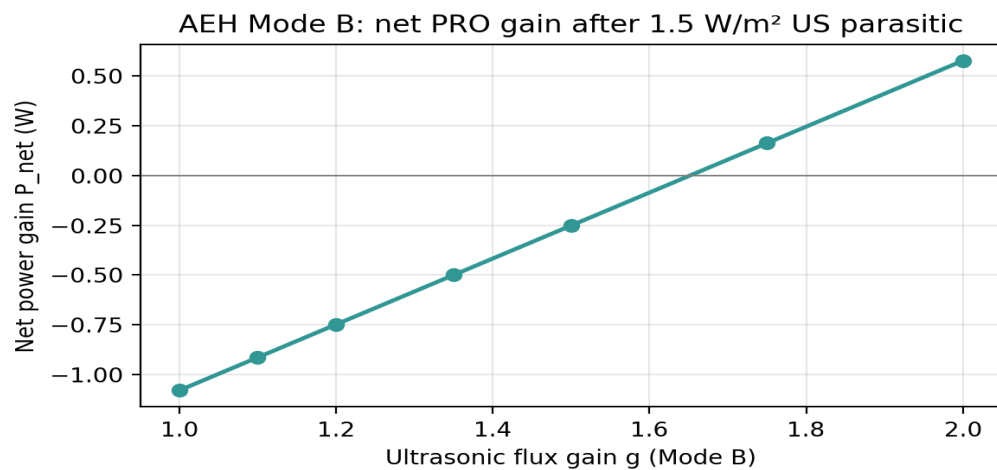


Figure 6. Net power versus flux gain g .

6.9 Experiment E6 — Acoustic harvest

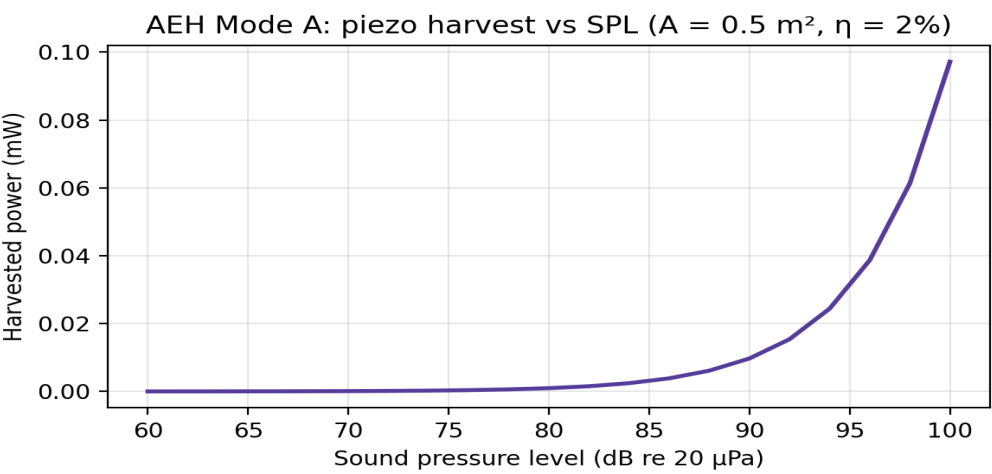


Figure 7. Mode A harvest versus SPL.

Table 10. Selected SPL harvest points ($A=0.5 \text{ m}^2$, $\eta=2\%$).

SPL dB	I W/m ²	P mW
60	9.72e-07	0.000
80	9.72e-05	0.001
100	9.72e-03	0.097

7. Hardware realization

The CHORUS-Skid frame (664×480.0×900 mm) supports a membrane housing OD 280 mm, length 264 mm, bolt circle 240 mm. PRO fluid path includes feed/draw manifolds, pressure vessel rings, end caps, PX module, turbine housing, and relief valve block.

PRO-01 through PRO-09 cover the wetted stack. CHOR-01 enclosure provides thermal/moist plenum. AEH-01 panel and AEH-02 ultrasonic mount ring attach without penetrating the high-pressure draw circuit. STR-01 frame, STR-02 drip tray, STR-03 rails contain brine leaks per FR-4.

Utilities UT-01–UT-05 include pump mount, sensor bracket, and tank adapters (feed/brine/flange). v2 module RED-01 red_cartridge_v2.scad shares bolt pattern for nanopore RED experiments on the same skid.

Materials: SS316 wetted paths; EPDM gaskets; membrane sheet vendor TBD (FO/PRO class). P&ID: low-sal tank → feed pump → prefilter → feed manifold → membrane stack → draw manifold → PX/throttle → turbine/motor load → brine return. Rupture disk at $1.2 \times \Delta P^*$.

Electrical: GFCI on pump/DAQ; piezo rectifier to supplemental bus; US driver on isolated supply. See hardware/bom/SGH1_BOM.csv for 35+ line items and hardware/electrical/WIRING.md for channel map.

7.1 Safety and pressure systems

Draw-side pressure rating must exceed $1.25 \times$ test pressure per SGH1_TEST_PROTOCOL. Rupture disk set at $1.2 \times \Delta P^* \approx 41$ bar protects housing and manifolds.

Brine chemistry requires eye wash, chemical-resistant gloves, and drip tray containment (FR-4). No hydrotest with glass viewport components. Electrical GFCI on all pump and DAQ circuits.

Ultrasonic drivers are isolated from low-voltage DAQ to prevent ground loops. Acoustic panel mounting avoids resonant contact with draw high-pressure piping.

7.2 Net energy balance (parasitics)

Complete skid net power $P_{\text{net}} = P_{\text{PRO}} + P_{\text{AEH}} + P_{\text{US,net}} - P_{\text{pump}} - P_{\text{aux}}$ is not yet closed in code. Feed pump power scales roughly with $Q \times \Delta P_{\text{pump}} / \eta_{\text{pump}}$. At $Q = 0.15$ L/min and $\Delta P_{\text{pump}} \sim 1\text{--}3$ bar for pretreatment, parasitics may be comparable to modeled PRO output until PX recovery is included—PRO-07 px_module is the designed mitigation path.

Pressure exchangers can return a fraction of draw-side pressurization energy to the feed path, dramatically improving net efficiency in commercial PRO. SGH-1 includes PX housing in CAD to train integrators even before turbine/generator substitution is finalized.

DAQ budget under 2 W is negligible versus PRO target. Ultrasonic driver at $1.5 \text{ W/m}^2 \times 0.72 \text{ m}^2 \approx 1.08$ W is material and appears in E5 as P_{US} .

Table 11. Representative CAD index (23 parts total).

ID	Part	Role
PRO-01	membrane_housing	Stack shell
PRO-05/06	manifolds	Feed / draw

ID	Part	Role
PRO-07	px_module	Pressure exchange
AEH-01	chorus_aeh_panel	6×4 cells
CHOR-01	skid_enclosure	Plenum
STR-01	skid_frame	Structure

8. Bench and field test protocol

T0 — Coupon test: Air leak test 3 bar, 10 min; water flush; establish feed 5 g/L and draw 80 g/L simulant; ramp ΔP from 0 $\rightarrow$ $0.5\Delta\pi \rightarrow \Delta P^*$ over 30 min; log at 1 Hz. Pass: no leaks, positive steady power 15 min.

T1 — Full stack: Hydrotest draw at $1.25 \times \Delta P^*$; 1 h steady run; compare P'' to simulation $\pm 30\%$. This directly tests L_p calibration and CP losses.

T2 — Field sidestream: Utility NDA; tie-in to real brine and effluent; replicate logging.

AEH tests: SPL meter at panel; Voc into 1 M Ω ; US on/off comparison for Mode B flux gain.

8A. Worked numerical examples

Worked example 1 (estuary RED): With $c_{\text{sea}} = 600$, $c_{\text{river}} = 20 \text{ mol/m}^3$, $T = 298.15 \text{ K}$, $E_N = 87.39 \text{ mV}$ per pair. Fifty pairs $\rightarrow V_{\text{oc}} = 4.37 \text{ V}$. If $P''_{\text{max}} = 15 \text{ W/m}^2$, then $R_{\text{int}} = V_{\text{oc}}^2 / (4 P'') = 0.318 \Omega \cdot \text{m}^2$.

Worked example 2 (brine PRO): $c_{\text{draw}} = 1400$, $c_{\text{feed}} = 5 \rightarrow \Delta\pi = 6.92 \text{ MPa}$. At $\Delta P = \Delta\pi/2$, $L_p = 1 \times 10^{-12}$, $A = 0.72 \text{ m}^2$, $\eta_{\text{mem}} \eta_{\text{hyd}} = 0.35 \times 0.55 \rightarrow P \approx 1.66 \text{ W}$. To reach 10 W , scale L_p to $6.03 \times 10^{-12} \text{ m/(Pa} \cdot \text{s)}$ or add membrane area beyond twelve plates.

Worked example 3 (mixing ceiling): $\Delta\pi_{\text{estuary}} \times Q = 1438 \text{ MW}$ at $Q = 500 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$ illustrates that bulk mixing power is enormous but inaccessible without controlled interface area and membrane technology.

8B. Ranked concepts and deployment path

The CHORUS notebook exports four ranked concept tags used throughout the program:

Safest: PRO salinity-gradient core. **Smartest:** Ultrasonic CP gain + PRO. **Strangest:** TSC + AEH urban panel. **Civilization-scale:** Co-located desal brine + effluent + CHORUS skid.

These tags are communication devices, not performance guarantees. Safest maps to Tier-1 bench PRO. Smartest maps to AEH Mode B contingent on positive E5 net gain. Strangest maps to Tier-2 TSC. Civilization maps to column Monte Carlo only.

Deployment targets co-located desalination and wastewater treatment plants where brine and effluent are available without new intake infrastructure. SGH1_PATENT_AND_DEPLOYMENT.md outlines claim focus on PRO-on-brine plus ultrasonic CP assist plus integrated DAQ—not on column MW totals.

Outreach sequence: (1) bench T0/T1 at lab simulant; (2) pilot T2 at utility sidestream; (3) scale membrane area or plate count toward kW-class if L_p validates. Regulatory path follows existing industrial water handling, not new estuary impingement.

Economic viability requires net positive skid power after pump, pretreatment, and US parasitics—a calculation deferred until parasitics.py is integrated. Even at 10 W bench proof, the learning value is membrane characterization under real $\Delta\pi$, not immediate LCOE competitiveness.

8C. Notebook reproducibility map

notebooks/CHORUS_physics_proof.ipynb implements §I–VIII: symbolic Gibbs and Nernst (SymPy); RED slip conductance sweep (NumPy); MEG flux (NumPy); PV thermal ODE (SciPy solve_ivp); Butler–Volmer SMFC; global circuit; TSC Kirchhoff; column Monte Carlo with boxplots.

The final cell exports chorus_results.json consumed by this paper and pdf-genesis. notebooks/SGH1_PRO_simulation.ipynb repeats PRO sizing with AEH sweeps for hardware teams.

Re-running notebooks after parameter changes is mandatory for publication integrity—JSON exports are the single source of truth for tables in Section 6 and Appendix A.

9. Discussion

Sidestream PRO wins the near-term race because infrastructure exists: tanks, pumps, permits, and operators. Estuary RED requires greenfield environmental permitting and long membrane interfaces in biofouling waters.

The 1.66 W vs 10 W gap is the central honest tension. It is not fraud—it is an explicit call for membrane characterization. Literature PRO foils after conditioning often exceed bare 1×10^{-12} m/(Pa·s).

Column median 22.9 MW/km² is a thought experiment with PV-dominated area weights. Investors and policymakers must not conflate it with SGH-1 bench watts.

TSC and global circuit layers are valuable for systems storytelling and patent differentiation but must not appear in spec sheets as measured performance.

Ultrasonic CP assist is promising where feed salinity is high and J_w is large enough that polarization loss exceeds driver parasitics—exactly the brine/effluent regime.

Open-source release (differential-harness) enables third-party falsification—critical for pre-revenue hardware science.

9.1 Claims hierarchy (summary)

Table 12. Claims tiering for stakeholders.

Tier	Claim	Evidence status
1	PRO $\Delta\pi$, ΔP^* sizing	Model + CAD
1	Kim–Baker peak	E1 sweep
1	L_p calibration needed	E2, Π
2	Column 22 MW/km ²	E7 MC, PV-dominated
2	TSC routing	Illustrative G
2	AEH mW harvest	E6, Mode A

10. Conclusion and future work

CHORUS-SGH-1 delivers a complete, falsifiable pipeline from osmotic thermodynamics to bench hardware. Joseph Black PoC report v3 adds exhaustive layer theory, seven numerical experiments, seven figures, and explicit separation of tier-1 PRO/AEH claims from tier-2 column/TSC narratives. The central engineering action is bench validation of L_p and CP on anthropogenic brine—not re-litigating whether PV dominates land area.

10.1 Future work

Integrate pump parasitics and PX efficiency into simulation/parasitics.py for net skid energy balance.

Couple salt permeability B to draw dilution over time (transient PRO).

Field T2 at co-located desal + WWTP; publish bench CSV alongside model.

Validate TSC conductances with soil–water–atmosphere potential monitoring.

v2 RED cartridge swap experiments on shared bolt pattern.

Publish peer-reviewed version with verified DOIs for calibration anchors.

Appendix A — Estuary RED reference values

Table 13. From chorus_results.json.

Quantity	Value
E_N	87.39 mV
V_stack (50 pair)	4.37 V
$\Delta\pi$	2.876 MPa
P''_blue	15 W/m ²
R_int	0.318 $\Omega \cdot \text{m}^2$
P_mix ceiling	1438 MW

Appendix B — E1 pressure-ratio sweep (sample)

Table 14. Every fourth point of 41-point sweep.

$\Delta P / \Delta \pi$	P (W)	Q (L/min)
0.05	0.31	0.284
0.14	0.80	0.257
0.23	1.17	0.230
0.32	1.44	0.203
0.41	1.60	0.176
0.50	1.66	0.149
0.59	1.60	0.123
0.68	1.44	0.096
0.77	1.17	0.069
0.86	0.80	0.042
0.95	0.31	0.015

Appendix C — E2 L_p sweep (full)

L _p × 10 ¹²	P (W)	P''	≥10W
0.5	0.83	1.15	N
1.0	1.66	2.30	N
2.0	3.31	4.60	N
4.0	6.63	9.21	N
6.0	9.94	13.81	N
8.0	13.26	18.42	Y
10.0	16.57	23.02	Y
15.0	24.86	34.53	Y

Appendix D — E5 ultrasonic (full)

g	P _{base}	P _{us}	P _{net}
1.00	1.66	1.08	-1.080
1.10	1.66	1.08	-0.914
1.20	1.66	1.08	-0.749
1.35	1.66	1.08	-0.500
1.50	1.66	1.08	-0.251
1.75	1.66	1.08	0.163
2.00	1.66	1.08	0.577

Appendix E — CAD file list

- hardware/openscad/sgh1_assembly.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_exploded_assembly.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_membrane_housing.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_membrane_plate.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_manifold_feed.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_manifold_draw.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_px_module.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_turbine_housing.scad

- hardware/openscad/chorus_aeh_panel.scad
- hardware/openscad/chorus_skid_enclosure.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_skid_frame.scad
- hardware/openscad/sgh1_red_cartridge_v2.scad

Appendix F — Reproducibility commands

```
python -m simulation.experiments
```

```
python -m simulation.pi_groups
```

```
python simulation/run_sizing.py --power 10 --density 8
```

```
python scripts/generate_paper_figures.py
```

```
python scripts/build_research_paper.py
```

```
pytest
```

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